PHASE 1 — CORE FOUNDATION (SETUP)

These are not “optional.” Skip them and the whole thing collapses later.

1. Project Skeleton

- `/public` → index.php, assets
- `/app` → Models, Controllers, Database connection
- `/views` → Templates
- `/config` → DB credentials
- Routing via simple `index.php?page=...` or a tiny router.

2. Database Schema

Tables:

- `admins`
- `companies`
- `cars`
- `inquiries`
- `pages` (about/contact)
- `users` (optional for now)

Get this correct first or you’ll regret everything.

PHASE 2 — ADMIN AUTH MODULE (BUILD FIRST!)

Don’t touch car listing until the admin login works.

Modules:

- **Admin Login**
- **Session handling**
- **Password hashing**
- **Profile edit**
- **Change password**
- **Forgot password** (email or token-based)

Admin auth is your security baseline. Build this before anything else.

PHASE 3 — ADMIN DASHBOARD CORE MODULES

1. Company Management

CRUD:

- Add company
- Update company
- View company list
- Delete company (soft delete recommended)

2. Car Management

CRUD:

- Add car
  - Title
  - Model
  - Price
  - Description
  - Company_id
  - Images (single/multiple uploads)
- Update car
- Delete car
- List cars with pagination

This is the biggest part of the system.

3. Inquiry Management

- View inquiry list
- Mark as read
- Assign status
- Save inquiry logs
- Delete/archive inquiry

4. Inquiry Search

Filters:

- Inquiry ID
- Name
- Email
- Phone
- Date range
- Status

This is literally just a SQL WHERE builder.

PHASE 4 — STATIC PAGE MANAGEMENT

Table: `pages`
Fields:

- `slug` (about-us, contact-us)
- `title`
- `content`

Admin can edit these pages through a WYSIWYG editor (TinyMCE or Summernote).

Frontend reads from DB.

PHASE 5 — FRONTEND USER SIDE

1. Homepage

- Featured cars
- Search form
- Basic categories (SUV, sedan, etc., optional)

2. Car Listing

- Filters: price range, brand/company, model, year
- Pagination
- Car thumbnail card

3. Car Details Page

- Images
- Specifications
- Price
- Inquiry form for that car
- Related cars

4. Inquiry Form

- Car ID
- Name
- Email
- Message
- Save to DB
- Admin sees immediately

PHASE 6 — NON-NEGOTIABLE UTILITIES

1. File/Image Upload Module

- Secure upload
- Validation
- Storage folder setup
- Thumbnail generation (optional)

2. Form Validation

- Server-side validation for all input
- Sanitization (HTML escaping)
  You already know why this is important.

3. Error Handling

- Graceful error page
- Logging

PHASE 7 — OPTIONAL BUT BOOSTS MARKS

- User registration system
- Wishlist
- Compare cars
- Dashboard for normal users
- Notifications to admin for new inquiry
- Email reply to user
- PDF export for inquiry
- Multi-image gallery
- Search autocomplete

DELIVERABLE VERSIONS

Here’s how you should build it incrementally.

Version 0.1

- Project structure
- Database connection
- Admin login

Version 0.2

- Company CRUD
- Car CRUD

Version 0.3

- Inquiry + Inquiry Search

Version 0.4

- Pages management

Version 0.5

- Frontend listing + car details

Version 1.0

- Full functional marketplace

```
project_root/
|
├── public/                 # Only folder visible to browser
|   ├── index.php             # Front controller
|   ├── assets/
|   |   ├── css/
|   |   ├── js/
|   |   ├── images/
|   |   └── uploads/          # Car photos stored here
|   └── .htaccess             # URL rewriting, security
|
├── app/
|   ├── Controllers/
|   |   ├── AuthController.php
|   |   ├── DashboardController.php
|   |   ├── CompanyController.php
|   |   ├── CarController.php
|   |   ├── InquiryController.php
|   |   └── PageController.php
|   |
|   ├── Models/
```

```
│   │   ├── Admin.php
│   │   ├── Company.php
│   │   ├── Car.php
│   │   ├── Inquiry.php
│   │   └── Page.php
│   │
│   ├── Views/              # Only HTML/PHP templates
│   │   ├── admin/
│   │   │   ├── login.php
│   │   │   ├── dashboard.php
│   │   │   ├── companies/
│   │   │   ├── cars/
│   │   │   ├── inquiries/
│   │   │   └── pages/
│   │   ├── frontend/
│   │   │   ├── home.php
│   │   │   ├── car-list.php
│   │   │   ├── car-details.php
│   │   │   ├── about.php
│   │   │   └── contact.php
│   │   └── layouts/
│   │       ├── header.php
│   │       ├── footer.php
│   │       └── admin-layout.php
│   │
│   ├── Helpers/
│   │   ├── functions.php
│   │   ├── Validator.php
│   │   └── Upload.php
```

```
|   |
|   └── Core/
|       ├── Database.php
|       ├── Session.php
|       ├── Controller.php
|       └── Router.php
|
├── config/
|   └── config.php            # DB credentials, constants
|
├── storage/                  # Logs, backups, temp files
|   ├── logs/
|   └── cache/
|
├── vendor/                   # If you ever use Composer
|
└── README.md
```